

PHASE 1 PROPOSAL WALKTHROUGH

Building the operating foundation for digital gift cards

Discovery gave us a clear end-to-end view of how digital gift card orders are processed today. The biggest opportunity is to turn a manual, brittle fulfillment workflow into one Progressive's team can run securely and repeatedly.

RECOMMENDED FIRST BUILD

Secure Card Vault and Fulfillment Tool

A secure internal system for paid digital gift card orders, digital inventory, merchant-specific fulfillment steps, customer-ready files, and order history.

WHAT WE SET OUT TO ANSWER

The discovery engagement was designed to avoid guessing at the build.

In the first walkthrough, we framed digital gift cards as cash-equivalent data and recommended structured discovery before committing to a solution. The work was meant to clarify the current workflow, security boundaries, merchant requirements, and what Progressive should build next.

Operational dependency

Understand where fulfillment depended on specific people, local files, scripts, and undocumented steps.

Secure handling

Identify how card numbers, PINs, claim codes, URLs, generated PDFs, and delivery emails move through the process.

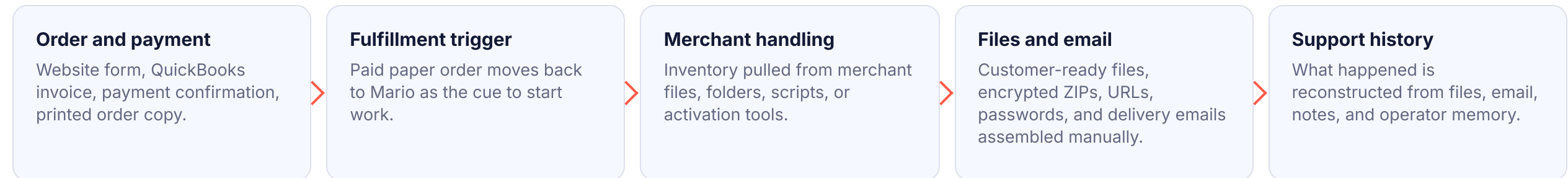
Right first build

Decide whether the next step should be card generation, customer access, ordering, or a stronger internal fulfillment foundation.

WHAT DISCOVERY SHOWED

The behind-the-scenes workflow carries real risk and is painful to operate.

Digital cards are cash-equivalent. Today they move through a chain of paper, spreadsheets, Google Drive folders, scripts, generated files, email, and person-specific knowledge.



THE PRACTICAL RISK

The workflow works because specific people know how to run it.

That is the point of fragility. If volume grows, a key person is away, a script fails, a merchant changes its format, or an order needs support later, Progressive does not have one controlled place to see what happened.

Person-dependent

Process knowledge lives with specific people, not in the system.

Folder-dependent

The workflow relies on the right local and Drive folder structure.

Script-dependent

Some merchants depend on scripts and templates that are hard for staff to support.

Email-dependent

Delivery history and support context are split across email and generated files.

RECOMMENDATION

Build the Secure Card Vault and Fulfillment Tool first.

The vault gives Progressive one controlled internal workflow for paid digital gift card orders, digital inventory, inventory allocation, merchant-specific fulfillment steps, customer-ready files, and order history.

It solves the biggest risk first, can be built as a standalone operating tool, and creates the foundation for the customer portal and future service layers.

WHAT THE VAULT CHANGES

From scattered handoffs to one repeatable workflow.

TODAY

Disconnected tools and memory

Paid order

Paper copy + operator memory

Inventory

Merchant spreadsheets

Fulfillment steps

Folders, scripts, know-how

Delivery

Email + encrypted files

Support history

Reconstructed after the fact

PHASE 1 CONSOLIDATES EVERY STEP INTO ONE SECURE WORKFLOW

AFTER PHASE 1

One connected system

THE SECURE CARD VAULT

Order intake

Pending queue or manual entry



Vault inventory

By merchant & denomination



Allocation + status

Ready or missing, flagged



Customer-ready file

Generated from inventory



Order history

Logged automatically

MERCHANT FULFILLMENT REALITY

The system should support three different merchant patterns.

Merchant-provided digital inventory

Most merchants provide usable card details: URLs, PDFs, card numbers, PINs, access codes, or spreadsheet inventory. Progressive pulls from inventory, prepares the customer-ready file, and delivers it.

Progressive-generated PDFs

A smaller group, including Amazon, Loblaws, and Shoppers Drug Mart, requires Progressive to generate card PDFs from raw card data.

Walmart

Walmart is a separate just-in-time activation flow with its own activation tool, generated PDFs, and monthly reconciliation requirements.

Sequence the work so each phase makes the next one easier.

1

Secure card vault

Internal fulfillment foundation for pending digital orders, manual/admin orders, card inventory, merchant workflows, customer-ready files, and order history.

- Operational risk reduction
- Secure handling of card data
- Supportable process for staff

2

Order platform and customer portal

Replace or upgrade the current Formidable Forms pseudo-commerce flow with customer accounts, order submission, order history, status, retrieval, QuickBooks integration, and deeper Card Vault integration.

- Better customer experience
- Cleaner admin tools
- Paid-order status flowing into fulfillment

3

Service expansion modules

Add capabilities once the foundation exists, including recipient delivery, reporting where merchants allow it, and merchant-branded portals.

- New service layers
- Partnership opportunities
- More controlled distribution

PHASE 1 BOUNDARY

The first build should stay focused on internal fulfillment.

Include in Phase 1

Website order handoff into pending vault requests, or an agreed fallback intake method, plus manual/admin order creation.

Fulfillment dashboard, request list, request detail, open/closed status, and payment-status tracking.

Digital Card Vault with CSV import, merchant/denomination inventory counts, allocation, and status.

Customer-ready CSV/export creation once inventory is allocated.

Order activity history for key actions: created, paid, allocated, exported, closed, deleted, or returned to inventory.

Production security foundation: authenticated access, roles, encrypted card data, backups, logging, and separate staging/production environments.

Planned for Phase 2 and Phase 3

Full customer portal or customer account system.

Replacing the entire public ordering experience.

QuickBooks invoice creation or accounting integration.

Direct recipient delivery as a managed service.

Secure delivery portal, download links, and customer access logging.

Automated delivery emails from the vault.

Direct merchant integrations or automatic card issuing.

Automation of third-party merchant websites, activation portals, or login-based merchant workflows.

Walmart monthly reconciliation automation.

Full physical card warehouse/pick-pack workflow.

Redemption reporting where merchant data is not available.

Merchant-branded portals.

Additional merchant formats or file-creation rules beyond the agreed Phase 1 set.

PHASE 1 PROPOSAL

Recommended build: Secure Card Vault and Fulfillment Tool.

PROJECT FEE

\$32,000 CAD + tax

Fixed fee for the scoped Phase 1 build.

ESTIMATED TIMELINE

6–8 weeks

From kickoff, assuming timely access, source materials, decisions, and consolidated feedback.

WHAT THE PHASE 1 FEE COVERS

Core workflow

Pending order intake, manual/admin order entry, fulfillment queue, payment-status updates, inventory allocation, customer-ready file creation, and closeout.

Inventory view

Track digital gift cards by merchant, denomination, quantity, source, status, allocation, and use.

Secure handling

Authenticated admin access, role-based permissions, field-level encryption for card numbers/PINs, restricted production access, backups, and action history.

Support path

Launch support is included. Ongoing maintenance or operational support can be handled through a separate support agreement or approved T&M request.

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Review and approve the Phase 1 SOW.

If Progressive agrees with the recommendation, the next step is approval of the Phase 1 Statement of Work so Redstamp can move into kickoff, production planning, and implementation.

Confirm direction

Phase 1 focuses on the Secure Card Vault and Fulfillment Tool.

Approve SOW

Progressive approves the scoped fee, timeline, payment schedule, assumptions, and out-of-scope boundaries.

Keep the roadmap visible

Phase 2 and Phase 3 remain sequenced options, not distractions from the first build.